

PREPARED FOR MOTION MEDIA GROUP

# Two versions of Tubes. One live picture of the slate.

Martin, this is the full proposal behind the one-pager: chapter by chapter, how Tubes does what it claims. Production companies run their productions in **Tubes Production**; Motion Media Group follows every production, every company and all companies together in **Tubes Portfolio**. A one-page summary and a demo video accompany this document.

| PREPARED FOR                                            | FROM                       | SUBJECT                               | NEXT STEP                  |
|---------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------|---------------------------------------|----------------------------|
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# What the pilot needs to prove

Everything in this proposal serves one decision: connect one real production and test whether Tubes gives MMG earlier, more reliable financial visibility without taking operational control away from the production company. Four questions decide it.

## EARLIER

### **Forecast movement before the reporting cycle**

Do you see commitments and ETC move the EFC before the normal report would show it?

## COMPARABLE

### **One financial structure across companies**

Can different production companies report through the same structure?

## LESS MANUAL

### **Consolidation without assembly**

Does MMG spend less time collecting and consolidating reports?

## NON-INTRUSIVE

### **Visibility without takeover**

Does the production company keep running its production, workflows intact?

The chapters that follow explain how Tubes intends to prove those four things with one real production.

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## CHAPTER 2 · TWO VERSIONS OF TUBES

# One follows. The other runs.

Tubes is production software with management overviews on top, for one or more underlying production companies. The companies work in it; Motion Media Group watches over it. That distinction matters, because it means MMG never has to operate inside a production's books to see what is happening in them. Tubes Portfolio is a control layer built on the live production data underneath, not another dashboard fed by reports.

FOR MOTION MEDIA GROUP

## MMG Tubes Portfolio

- One live view over every connected production, built on the data underneath
- Early warnings the day a forecast moves past budget
- Cashflow and margin forecast per company, month, quarter, year
- Price per minute and per episode, comparable across the slate
- Drill-down: portfolio → company → production → invoice
- Read-only share links for investor reporting
- Standard setup and templates, rolled out group-wide

Follow and steer, without running the productions.

FOR EVERY COMPANY OR FILM YOU FINANCE

## Tubes Production

- One or more productions and series per workspace
- Create projects; build budgets or import Movie Magic directly
- Real-time cost control: budget → PO → invoice → forecast
- Invoice processing with automatic reading and approvals
- Xero or other accounting software, connected when wanted
- Day planning, call sheets and a crew app on the same data
- Local currency and language per company; fixed exchange rates per production

Run the production, head office sees the rollup.



FROM THE PRODUCT, THE PORTFOLIO ROLE

*"An investor, holding or group management. Rolls out a standard Tubes setup to its companies and follows every production, every company and all companies together."*

### CHAPTER 3 · GETTING CONNECTED

## How a production company joins

The connection is a weblink. Workspace setup takes minutes; operational adoption is gradual, along the phased path in chapter 12.

1

### MMG sends its signup link

The link carries your group profile: cost structure, roles, approval rules and, optionally, your standard budget and format templates.

## 2 The company creates its own workspace

Five to ten minutes of self-onboarding. The workspace arrives pre-configured, so every company across the group starts from the same structure and reports the same way.

## 3 The connection is live

From the first project the team creates, its numbers roll up into MMG's portfolio dashboard, automatically, in real time.

## 4 Support when needed, where needed

We support companies during signup, give training where that helps, and stay involved until a team runs on its own. Most teams need little of it; the point is that the help is there.

Tubes · Account setup, the signup wizard

PROGRESS

Step 1 of 6

- 1 Company profile** ±1 min  
Name, email & address
- 2 Logo & avatar ±1 min  
Make it recognisable
- 3 Team ±1 min  
Collaborate
- 4 Appearance 30 sec  
Your own style
- 5 Settings 30 sec  
Numbers & currency
- 6 Administration ±1 min  
Budget process & roles
- 7 Xero Optional  
Connect accounting

Your data is safe. Everything can be changed later.

● Ready in a few minutes

### Tell us about your company

Fill in the basics and you're good to go. You can always update this later.

Individual

**Company**

Organization

Team

Account name

Company name

Northside Pictures

e.g. Johnson Productions

Email address

Country

production@northside.ca

Canada

Next: Logo & avatar →

The signup wizard itself. Six short steps; the time estimates next to each step are the product's own, and they add up to about five minutes. That is the workspace setup for a new company: this wizard, pre-filled by your group profile. Operational adoption follows at the team's own pace.

## Motion Media Group

Tubes Portfolio · portfolio rollup, drill-down into every production

Off

Vendor

Portfolio

TUBES PRODUCTION

### Company A

3 productions connected

TUBES PRODUCTION

### Company B

1 production connected

TUBES PRODUCTION

### Company C

2 productions connected

NEXT SIGNING

Joins via your signup link

Workspace setup in minutes

## CHAPTER 4 · BUDGETS & MOVIE MAGIC

# Build the budget, or import it

A team can build its budget in Tubes: budget lines organised by cost group, versions to compare scenarios, a locked version as the approved baseline, and a work budget for the team's day-to-day view. Or, and this is the path we expect most of your teams to take, it **uploads its existing Movie Magic budget**, which becomes the live baseline in minutes. Nobody rebuilds anything.

Movie Magic is still widely used for building budgets, and teams that like it can keep it. The difference is everything that happens after the budget. Keep the tools that work; connect the information that matters.

Projects in Production

Demo Tubes



Create a budget

Start from a template, copy an existing one, let AI draft it, or import Movie Magic.

Generate AI Budget

+ Create New Budget

All (8)

Development (3)

Production (4)

Post Production (1)



Fox and the Forest

Development

Project start

22 feb 2026

Delivery

20 jun 2026



The Secret of the Wadden, Part 1

Production

Project start

10 sep 2024

Delivery

13 feb 2025



Echoes of Tomorrow

Post Production

Project start

3 jan 2025

Delivery

19 sep 2025

The projects home of a production company: every production with its status and dates. A budget starts from a template, a copy of an earlier production, an AI draft, or a Movie Magic import. Demo data, illustrative.

 Budget

© Additional costs

€ 64.625

Budget incl. additional

€ 76.600

Sales incl. additional

Lock version

Budget published, editing not possible

Sort: Cost group

Hide Sales

| ITEM                                          | QTY | UNIT     | UNIT PRICE | BUDGET   | SALES    |
|-----------------------------------------------|-----|----------|------------|----------|----------|
| <b>DEVELOPMENT</b>                            |     |          |            | € 35.700 | € 44.800 |
| <b>Head writer</b><br>Treatment + pilot       | 20  | Days     | € 850      | € 17.000 | € 22.000 |
| <b>Script coach</b><br>2 sessions per episode | 12  | Sessions | € 600      | € 7.200  | € 9.000  |
| <b>Format bible</b><br>Design + rights        | 1   | Fixed    | € 11.500   | € 11.500 | € 13.800 |
| <b>RECORDING ON LOCATION</b>                  |     |          |            | € 18.550 | € 26.050 |
| <b>Camera set 01</b><br>2x FX9 + lenses       | 7   | Days     | € 1.850    | € 12.950 | € 18.200 |
| <b>Sound + DIT</b><br>Location sound          | 7   | Days     | € 800      | € 5.600  | € 7.850  |
| <b>STORY &amp; RIGHTS</b>                     |     |          |            | € 1.000  | € 1.250  |
| <b>MONTAGE</b>                                |     |          |            | € 3.500  | € 4.500  |
| <b>Totals</b>                                 |     |          |            | € 58.750 | € 76.600 |

The budget builder: cost groups with budget and sales side by side, and a locked, published version as the approved baseline. Whether a budget is built here or arrives through Movie Magic import, this is the live baseline that commitments, invoices and the forecast attach to. Demo data, illustrative.

## Movie Magic

**A budgeting document.** Still widely used for building one.

Built for exactly that: constructing and pricing a budget.

The line producer's own working tool.

Its scope ends at the budget; the financial process continues elsewhere.

## Tubes

**A live system.** Imports that budget and connects it to POs, invoices, forecasts and final cost.

Multi-user, cloud, one workspace per company.

Shared by production, finance, and, rolled up, the group.

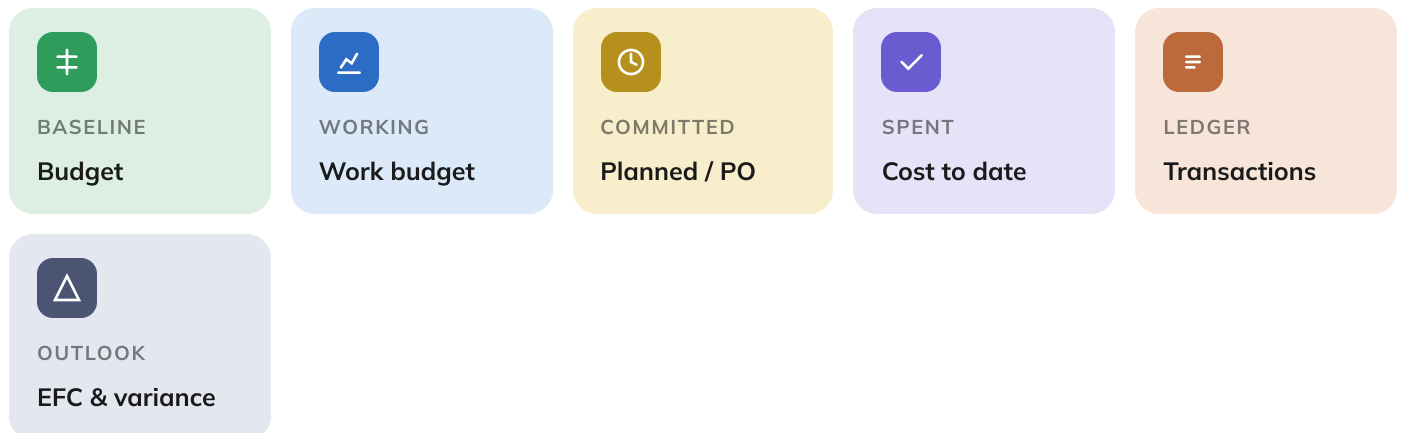
Adds planning, call sheets and the crew app on the same data.

MMG follows every production live in Tubes Portfolio, nobody has to send a file.

## CHAPTER 5 · COST CONTROL IN REAL TIME

# Six numbers, from first budget to final cost

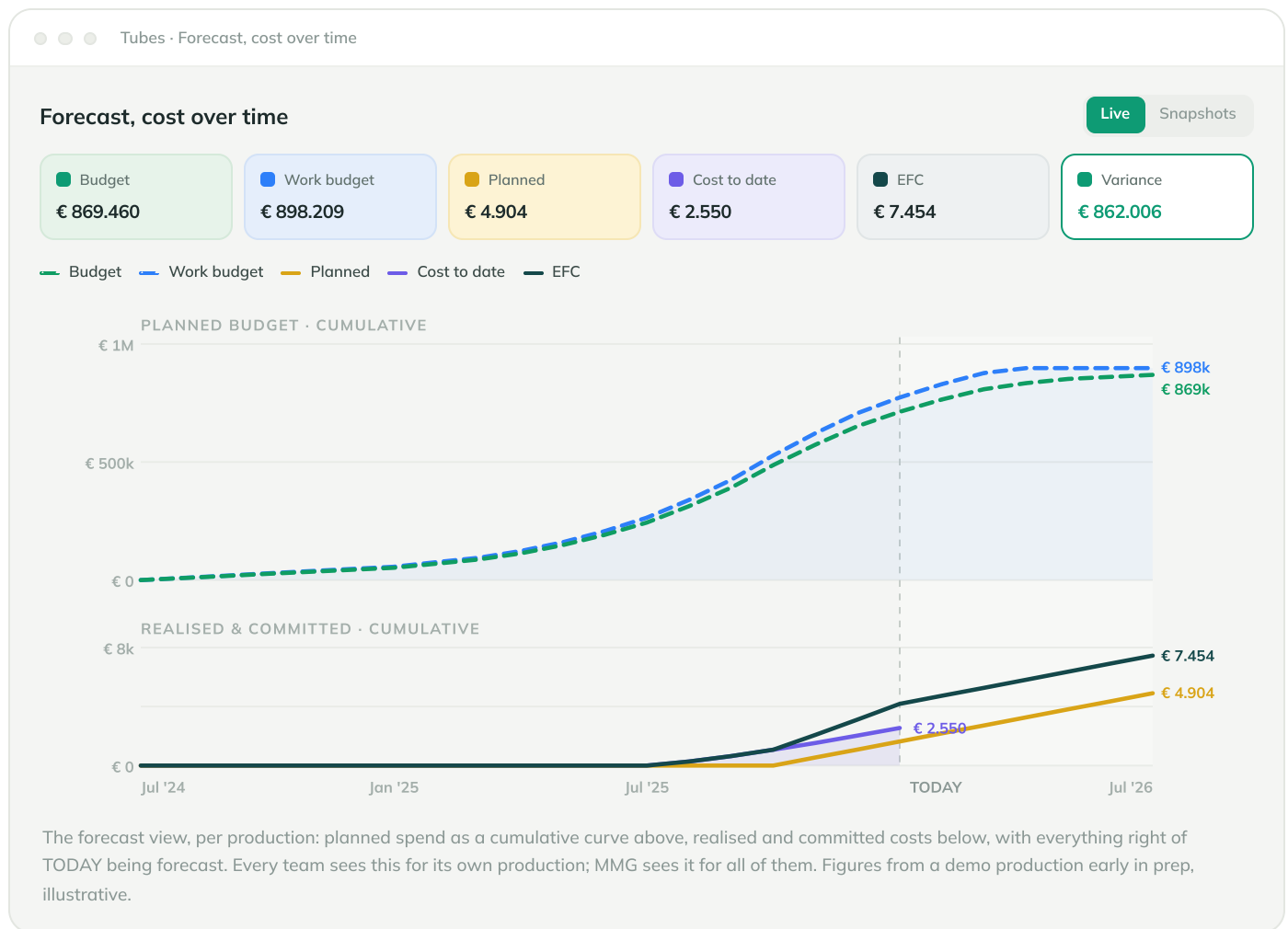
How it works: every purchase order and every invoice is entered **against a budget line**, that single discipline is what makes everything else automatic. The moment a PO is raised, the committed total and the estimated final cost move. The team sees its own variance live; nobody waits for a cost report to find out where they stand.



The model is always the same: **approved budget → work budget → committed (PO) → actuals (CTD) + ETC → EFC**, with variance and the cash requirement



following from it. Transactions are not a stage after CTD; they are the input that becomes CTD. The forecast stays anchored to actual costs and commitments, while ETC captures what the team still expects to spend.

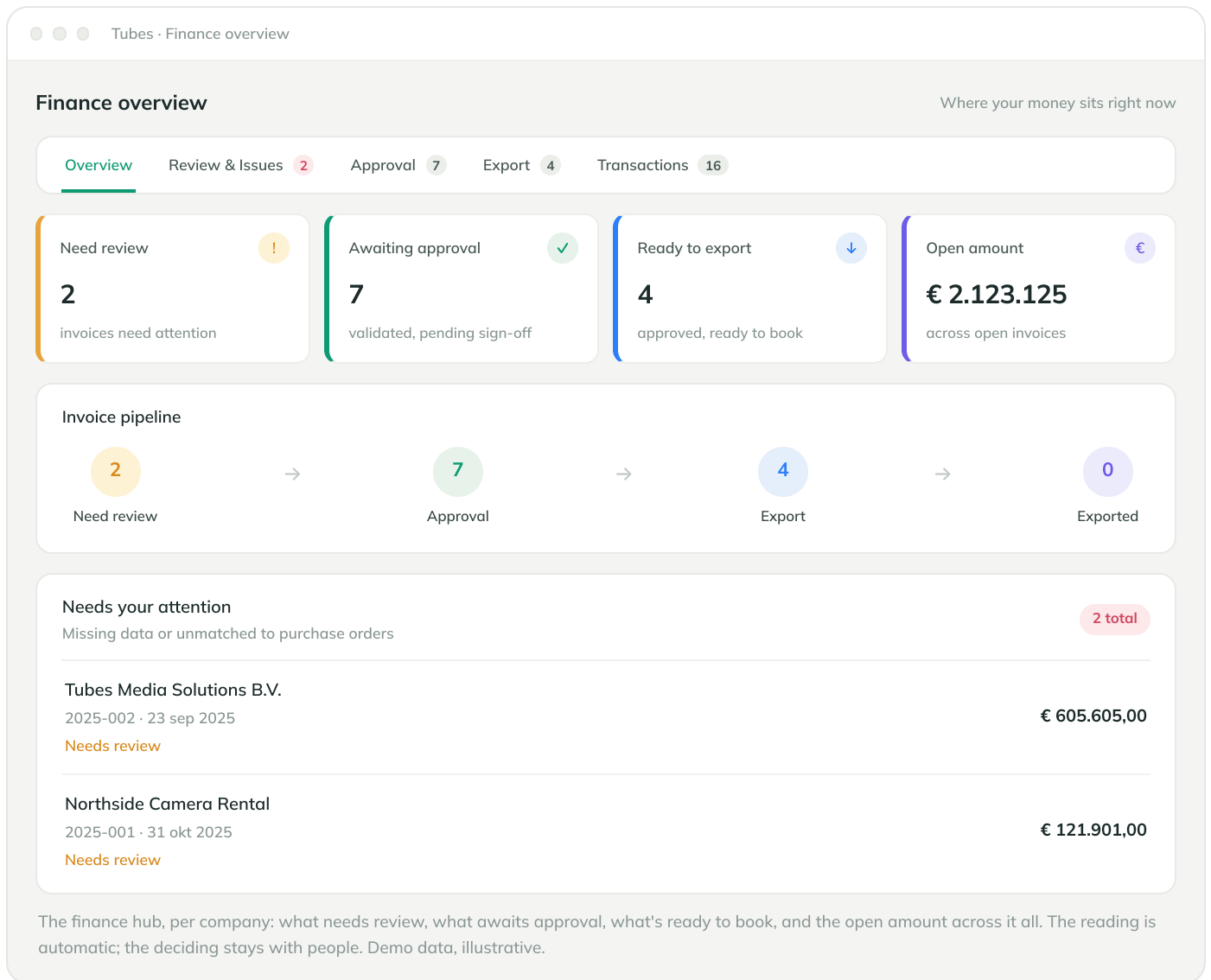


## CHAPTER 6 · INVOICES & ACCOUNTING

# From inbox to books, without re-keying

How it works: an invoice is dropped in (or mailed in), and Tubes reads it, supplier, amounts, dates, and proposes the budget line it belongs to. A person confirms; approval rules route it to whoever has to sign off at that amount. Once approved, it counts in cost to date and the forecast, immediately.

If the company uses **Xero or other accounting software**, the connection keeps the production ledger and the books aligned, no double entry, no month-end surprise where the two disagree. Teams that prefer exports get exports.



## CHAPTER 7 · THE PORTFOLIO DASHBOARD

# One dashboard over every connected production

From the portfolio workspace, every production of every connected company is followed **in real time**, one dashboard for progress across the slate. It's not a report that someone assembles: the portfolio view is built from the same live data the production teams work in every day.

| PRODUCTION                                   | STATUS            | BUDGET       | COMMITTED    | COST TO DATE | EFC          | VARIANCE   |
|----------------------------------------------|-------------------|--------------|--------------|--------------|--------------|------------|
| Northern Crossing<br>Company A · Feature     | ● Production      | \$8,400,000  | \$6,120,000  | \$4,385,200  | \$8,361,000  | +\$39,000  |
| The Long Season<br>Company A · Series, 8 eps | ● Production      | \$12,000,000 | \$9,870,000  | \$7,214,900  | \$11,986,000 | +\$14,000  |
| Salt Water<br>Company B · Feature            | ● Post production | \$5,150,000  | \$5,020,000  | \$4,890,400  | \$5,102,000  | +\$48,000  |
| Fireline<br>Company C · Documentary          | ● Approved        | \$1,900,000  | \$310,000    | \$122,600    | \$1,900,000  | —          |
| Portfolio                                    |                   | \$27,450,000 | \$21,320,000 | \$16,613,100 | \$27,349,000 | +\$101,000 |

Illustrative figures. In the live product every number drills down, portfolio → company → production → budget line → the individual invoice or PO behind it.

Tubes · Cost type detail, the bottom of the drill

Project: Fox and the Forest · Forecast · Cost type: 1002, BUDGET DEVELOPMENT

BUDGET

WORK BUDGET

PLANNED

COST TO DATE

EFC

VARIANCE

€ 10.000

€ 10.240

€ 3.000

€ 2.400

€ 5.400

€ 4.600

Cost to date

Planned

Remaining budget

1 planned cost not yet linked to a transaction

Link now

Planned costs & PO's

2 items · 1 to link

To link

Scenario workshop, writers room

Storyline BV · 3 days, incl. location

€ 2.000

Linked

Research trip Ardennes

Recce + location photos · € 900 linked

€ 1.000

Expectations total

€ 3.000

✓

Cost to date

Transactions linked to planned costs

Invoice, writers room day 1–2

Storyline BV · Invoice 2026-114 · linked to: Scenario workshop

€ 1.500

Freelance script editor

M. van Dijk · Invoice 2026-131 · linked to: Research trip Ardennes

€ 900

Cost to date total

€ 2.400

The bottom of the drill: one cost type of one production. Every PO and every invoice is linked to the budget line it belongs to, which is exactly why the portfolio numbers above can be trusted. Anything unlinked is flagged until someone deals with it. Demo data, illustrative.



### Early warnings

The dashboard flags a production the moment its forecast moves past budget, at commitment time, weeks before it would surface in a cost report.



### AI analysis

AI analyses support the group view: the assistant reads along with the numbers and flags what deserves attention, at group level and on set.

The same slate also reads as a **cashflow and margin forecast overview per production company**, switchable between month, quarter and year. For a capital-recycling model, this is the view that matters: when does cash go out, when does it come back, and what margin is each company on course to deliver.

Month

Quarter

Year

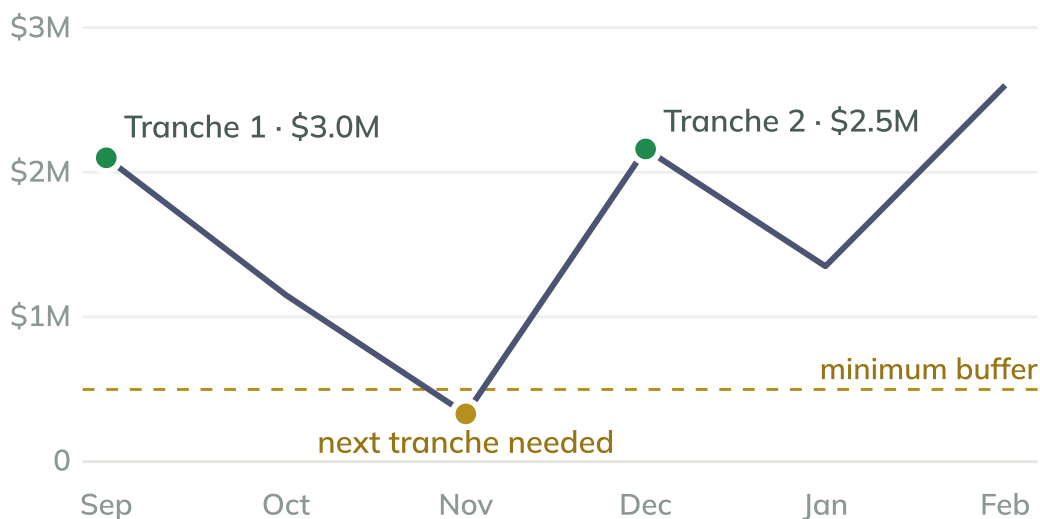
| COMPANY                                         | SEP 2026     | Q4 2026      | FY 2026      | MARGIN · FY 2026 |
|-------------------------------------------------|--------------|--------------|--------------|------------------|
| <b>Company A</b><br>2 productions in production | -\$1,240,000 | -\$2,850,000 | -\$5,400,000 | 14.2%            |
| <b>Company B</b><br>Delivering                  | +\$380,000   | +\$1,050,000 | +\$1,620,000 | 11.8%            |
| <b>Company C</b><br>Pre-production              | -\$210,000   | -\$640,000   | -\$980,000   | 17.5%            |
| <b>Portfolio</b>                                | -\$1,070,000 | -\$2,440,000 | -\$4,760,000 | 14.6%            |

Illustrative figures. Company A is in peak production (cash going out); Company B is delivering (cash coming back). The margin column is the forecast at completion, per company, from the same live production data.

Per production, the same forecast also reads as a **forward-looking cash requirement**: funding tranches in, spend drawing the position down, and a flag when the next tranche is needed.

## Forward-looking cash requirement

One feature film: tranches in, spend out, next tranche flagged ahead of time. Illustrative



Built from the production forecast, expected payment timing and funding tranches; receivables and incentives can be added where available. The same view rolls up per company and for the portfolio.

The same forecasts add up to the picture an investor actually asks about: how much capital is at work across the slate, and when it comes back.

## Capital at work across the slate

Deployed capital per month, deliveries bringing it back. Illustrative



Built from the production forecast, expected payment timing and funding tranches; receivables and incentives can be added where available. Deliveries bring capital plus margin back, and the live forecast shows when it comes free and when new commitments will need it. Illustrative.

And because every production carries its running time and episode count, the dashboard also shows the **unit economics**, the numbers your acquisitions side thinks in:

SERIES

**\$1.56M / episode**

The Long Season, forecast cost per episode, against a \$1.50M budget target.

FEATURE

**\$79k / finished minute**

Northern Crossing, 106 finished minutes on an \$8.4M budget.

COMPARABLE

**Same metric, every production**

Price per minute and per episode, computed from live forecasts, comparable across the whole slate.

Budgets and status snapshots can also be shared with outside stakeholders through **read-only links**, so investor reporting draws on live numbers instead of assembled spreadsheets.

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CHAPTER 8 · AI IN TUBES

## The assistant behind the production

AI in Tubes is there to remove the reading, checking and drafting that consumes production-finance time, not to make decisions on people's behalf. Every AI-generated suggestion is clearly identified, and every decision remains with a person. In Tubes, violet marks the assistant, so you always know what came from AI.



### Draft budgets

Describe the production, format and target amount, and the assistant creates a first budget for the team to refine. It gets a production to a workable starting point faster, particularly for recurring formats. The assistant drafts; the team decides.



### Read invoices and documents

Invoices are read automatically and key information is extracted: supplier, amounts, dates and a proposed budget line. A person confirms the result, and approvals remain human.



### Watch the numbers

As a production runs, the assistant monitors costs against budget and flags what deserves attention: by team or department on the production, and rolled up across the group for MMG.



### Learn from the finish

When a production wraps, the assistant compares budget to final cost by cost type and highlights what the next production could do differently.



### Translate automatically

Language does not have to be a barrier. The assistant translates between Tubes' ten supported languages, so an international production team and head office can work from the same information in their own language.

Every suggestion is visible, attributable and reversible. AI usage is managed through monthly credits per workspace, keeping the cost predictable.

## Where it's heading

The ambition is simple: empower productions to spend more time making things and less time reconciling spreadsheets, while giving the people financing them a live view of where things stand.

AI takes that further. The direction is towards operating Tubes through conversation: ask a question and get a live answer; give an instruction and have

the assistant prepare the work for a person to review and approve. The system does the work around the decision. The person stays in control.

Tubes Assistant

ROADMAP

How is The Long Season doing against budget?

It's **\$14k under**, the tightest margin on the slate. EFC is **\$11.99M** against a **\$12.0M** budget, with cost type 2000 CREW closest to its line. Want the breakdown per line?

Yes, and prepare a note for Thursday's production meeting.

Breakdown is open on your screen. The note is drafted and waiting for your approval before it goes to the team.

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## CHAPTER 9 · PLANNING, CALL SHEETS & CREW

# One plan, one source of truth

Production teams plan their days in Tubes, build call sheets directly from that planning, and publish them when they're ready. Schedules and published call sheets then land straight on the crew's phones through the Tubes mobile app: no PDF chains, no version confusion, no wondering which document is current.

And because the production plan sits alongside the budget, the operational and financial pictures stay connected. The people planning the work and the people tracking the money are working from the same underlying data, rather than maintaining two separate versions of the production.



Tubes · Planning

Planning10 aug 2026 – 16 aug 2026

CalendarCallsheets

| MONDAY<br>10                                                | TUESDAY<br>11                                               | WEDNESDAY<br>12                                         | THURSDAY<br>13                                                         |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 07:00 – 19:00<br>Shoot day 12 · The Long Season<br>Studio 4 | 07:00 – 19:00<br>Shoot day 13 · The Long Season<br>Studio 4 | 09:00 – 13:00<br>Location scout<br>Unit manager         | 08:00 – 18:00<br>Shoot day 14 · The Long Season<br>Location: Westergas |
| 20:00<br>Dailies review<br>Online · director & DoP          |                                                             | 14:00 – 17:00<br>Tech recce<br>The Secret of the Wadden | 10:00<br>Cast fitting<br>Reality & Competitie                          |

Callsheets

Per shooting day, status, distribution and crew

+ New callsheet

|           |                                                |               |         |
|-----------|------------------------------------------------|---------------|---------|
| 10<br>AUG | Callsheet #12<br>The Long Season · S1          | 07:00 / 19:00 | Sent    |
| 13<br>AUG | Callsheet #14<br>The Long Season · S1          | 08:00 / 18:00 | Draft   |
| 17<br>AUG | Callsheet #01<br>The Secret of the Wadden · S1 | 06:30 / 17:30 | Planned |

One week of a production: shoot days, prep and post side by side, and the callsheets that go with them. "Sent" means the crew already has it on their phones. Demo data, illustrative.

## CHAPTER 10 · CURRENCIES & LANGUAGES

# Built for a slate that crosses borders

Your productions already span jurisdictions, from Canada and Puerto Rico to India and Africa. Tubes is built for that reality from the start, with local currencies, local workflows and multilingual access, while giving the group a consistent view across the slate.

#### CURRENCY

##### Local currency, fixed FX

Each production company works in the currency it actually uses. Budgets, purchase orders and invoices stay in local currency, with a fixed exchange rate set for each production. The group can then report in a common currency without teams having to convert anything manually or worry about exchange-rate movements distorting the production budget.

#### LANGUAGE

##### 10 languages

Tubes supports 10 languages, set at workspace or individual-user level. A Dutch line producer and a Canadian accountant can work on the same production, each in their own language. Additional languages can be added as needed.

#### GETTING STARTED

##### Live in minutes, not weeks

A workspace can be set up quickly using standard templates and configuration. There is no need for a lengthy implementation project before a team can start working.

**How it works across borders.** The production company works entirely in its own local currency. Tubes handles the fixed exchange rate at production level, allowing the group rollup to report consistently without changing the underlying numbers.

#### COMPANY A · CANADA

##### Works in CA\$

Budgets, POs and invoices in Canadian dollars

#### COMPANY B · NETHERLANDS

##### Works in €

Entirely in euros, including the Xero connection

#### COMPANY C · PUERTO RICO

##### Works in US\$

Entirely in US dollars

### One portfolio, one reporting currency

Exchange rates fixed per production and applied consistently across the rollup, and every converted number still drills down to its local-currency source

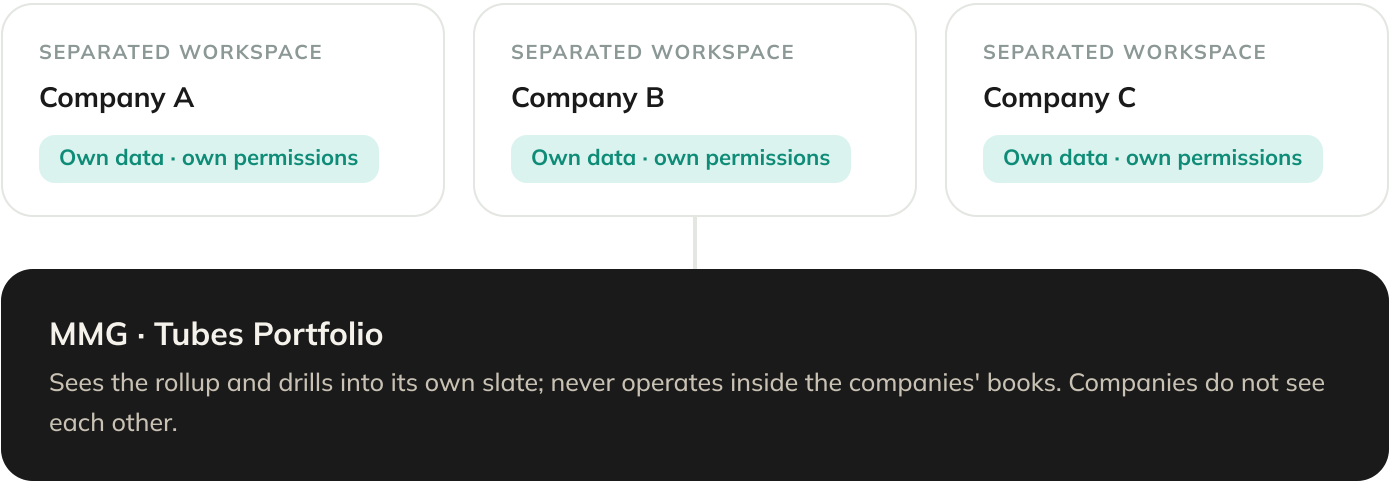
## CHAPTER 11 · DATA SEPARATION & PERMISSIONS

# Who sees what, by design

Every production company works in its own, separate workspace. Its data belongs to that company, with its own permissions and controls. MMG's portfolio workspace provides the group-level view, with the ability to drill into the productions it finances, without operating inside the company's books. Companies remain fully separated from one another.

Within each workspace, **role-based permissions** determine exactly who can see and do what. A line producer sees the productions they work on. A department head can be limited to their own work budget. An accountant can have access to the financial information they need without necessarily seeing rates. Approval rules can put a named person between a significant commitment and the money.

This same separation works at group level. MMG gets the transparency it needs across the productions it finances, while each company keeps control of its own data and operations. Portfolio access is read-only: MMG can see and drill into the data, but cannot edit it.



| ROLE                                                | PRODUCTION DETAIL      | RATES & SALARIES | FINANCE | GROUP ROLLUP |
|-----------------------------------------------------|------------------------|------------------|---------|--------------|
| <b>Line producer</b><br>runs the production         | ● Full                 | ● Full           | ● Full  | —            |
| <b>Department head</b><br>own work budget           | ● Own lines only       | —                | —       | —            |
| <b>Accountant</b><br>books & export                 | ● Full                 | —                | ● Full  | —            |
| <b>MMG · Tubes Portfolio</b><br>read-only oversight | ● Read-only drill-down | —                | —       | ● Full       |

How to read this: "Full" means the role sees and works in that area; "Own lines only" limits a department head to their own budget lines; the dash means no access. Illustrative permission set: every workspace defines its own roles and approval rules, this is a typical shape, not a fixed one.

# Gradual by design, starting with a pilot

Tubes doesn't ask a team to change the way it works all at once. Start with the data you already have, get visibility from day one, then bring more of the workflow into the system when the team is ready. Each team can move at its own pace, while the value builds from the start.

1

## Import and see

Workspaces created via your signup link. Current Movie Magic budgets imported. Costs start landing against budget lines. Your portfolio view is live.

First

2

## Control

Approval rules, forecasts and expectations, the accounting connection. Overruns surface at commitment time, group-wide.

Then

3

## Run

Day planning, call sheets and the crew app, production operations on the same data as the money.

When a team wants it

## The pilot

The quickest way to judge this is to look at one of your own productions through it.

- ✓ **Pick one production you finance.** Its team signs up through your link and imports its current budget.
- ✓ **Set up the MMG portfolio workspace,** configured with your standard setup and templates, ready to roll out further later.
- ✓ **Follow the production live:** budget, commitments, cost to date and forecast, from the portfolio dashboard down to the invoice.
- ✓ **Then decide.** If the picture isn't sharper than what you have today, that is the end of it.

Plan the walkthrough

or write me directly, [joachim@tubes.media](mailto:joachim@tubes.media)

# What's in the box

A complete overview of Tubes. Every role in the team gets the functionality, workflows and tools they need to do their job effectively, all in one system that brings the whole production together.

And Tubes keeps growing. We're continually covering more of the production process and taking administrative work off people's hands, leaving more time and headspace for the creative work.

## Develop & budget

- ✓ Project setup, briefing and funding
- ✓ Format templates, reusable across productions
- ✓ Budget builder with versions and a locked baseline
- ✓ Movie Magic budget import
- ✓ Budget compare for scenarios
- ✓ Commercial proposals for clients and commissioners
- ✓ AI budget drafting support (early version)
- ✓ Project documents, images and links in one place

## Plan & produce

- ✓ Day planning and scheduler
- ✓ Scenes & breakdown, stripbook (in development)
- ✓ Casting, recruitment and cast & crew management
- ✓ Locations
- ✓ Call sheets with status and distribution
- ✓ Crew app: schedules and callsheets on every phone
- ✓ Editing and delivery tracking
- ✓ Production dashboard per shoot day

## Control the money

- ✓ Work budgets per team member or department
- ✓ Planned costs and purchase orders
- ✓ Operational invoice processing with automatic reading
- ✓ Approval rules and transaction approval
- ✓ Transactions linked to budget lines

## Oversee & share

- ✓ MMG Tubes Portfolio: rollup over every company and production
- ✓ Cashflow and margin forecasts by month, quarter and year
- ✓ Early warnings when a forecast moves past budget
- ✓ AI analyses (early version)

- ✓ Live forecast and EFC, with views per role
- ✓ Cost reports: budget versus actuals per period, with historical snapshots
- ✓ Local currency per company, fixed exchange rates per production
- ✓ Xero and other API accounting connections

- ✓ Price per minute and per episode across the slate
- ✓ Read-only share links for investors and clients
- ✓ Role-based permissions and separated workspaces
- ✓ Signup links, standard setup and group-wide templates